

Board 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ A 8 2
♥ J 9 7 4
♦ K J 10 5 3
♣ J

♠ J 10 9 7 3

♥ A 8 2

♦ 6 2

♣ A 7 5



♠ 5 4

♥ Q 10 6 3

♦ 9 8

♣ Q 8 4 3 2

♠ K Q 6

♥ K 5

♦ A Q 7 4

♣ K 10 9 6

West	North	East	South
Pass	Pass	Pass	1NT
Pass	3♠	Pass	4♠
All Pass			
4♠ by North			
Lead: ♠4			

The bidding has been as shown.

Yes this is exactly the same hand you held in Deal 8. You still open 1NT. This time partner responds 3♠.

Partner shows 10+ points and exactly 5 ♠s. This time, with 3-card support, you choose game in ♠s, knowing there is an 8-card fit.

Board 2

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 7 5 3
♥ A 10 9 6
♦ 6 3
♣ 7 5 2

♠ A 10 9

♥ 8 3

♦ A K J 10 8 2

♣ J 8



♠ J 4 2

♥ J 7 5 2

♦ 9 5

♣ A Q 4 3

♠ K Q 6

♥ K Q 4

♦ Q 7 4

♣ K 10 9 6

The bidding has been as shown.

You open 1NT and partner says 3♦. It's your bid.

Partner has a great hand. A jump to 3 in a Minor suit almost always shows slam interest. But that's partner with interest, not you. You couldn't have a more minimum 1NT opening bid.

So you just return to 3NT. Partner gives up and passes.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
		Pass	1NT
Pass	3♦	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
3NT by South			
Lead: ♠7			

Board 3

East Deals

None Vul

♠ J 10 9 2
 ♥ 9 6 3
 ♦ Q 10 8 2
 ♣ 3 2

♠ 3
 ♥ A 8 5
 ♦ K J 3
 ♣ A Q 8 7 5 4

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♠ A 8 7 5 4
 ♥ J 10 7 2
 ♦ 9 6 5
 ♣ J

♠ K Q 6
 ♥ K Q 4
 ♦ A 7 4
 ♣ K 10 9 6

West	North	East	South
		Pass	1NT
Pass	3♣	Pass	4♣
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♦
Pass	6♣		
All Pass			
6♣ by North			
Lead: ♦ 5			

The bidding has been as shown.

You open 1NT and partner responds 3♣. What is your next bid?

Partner's jump to 3♣ shows at least 5 ♣s and slam interest. Your hand is good enough to encourage that interest so you bypass 3NT and say 4♣. Partner now bids 4NT. What do you answer?

That is Blackwood. You admit to one Ace and partner bids 6♣.

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A 7 5 2
 ♥ 5
 ♦ K 9 8 7 5
 ♣ A 7 2

♠ K 9 6
 ♥ K J 6 4
 ♦ A Q 4
 ♣ Q J 5



♠ J 10 4 3
 ♥ A 10
 ♦ J 10 3 2
 ♣ K 8 4

♠ Q 8
 ♥ Q 9 8 7 3 2
 ♦ 6
 ♣ 10 9 6 3

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
1 ♦	1NT	Pass	2 ♥
All Pass			
2 ♥ by South			
Lead: ♦ 5			

The bidding has been as shown.

A 1NT overcall is almost the same as a 1NT opening. The range is increased to 15-18, but the main difference is that you **must** have the opponent's suit adequately stopped. Here you certainly have the stopper so you bid 1NT. Partner responds 2 ♥.

And the responses are the same also. Partner's 2 ♥ bid is a signoff bid, often called a "drop dead" bid. So even though you really like the ♥s you pass.